# Data and the State

DATA 20195 / 30195

## Migration

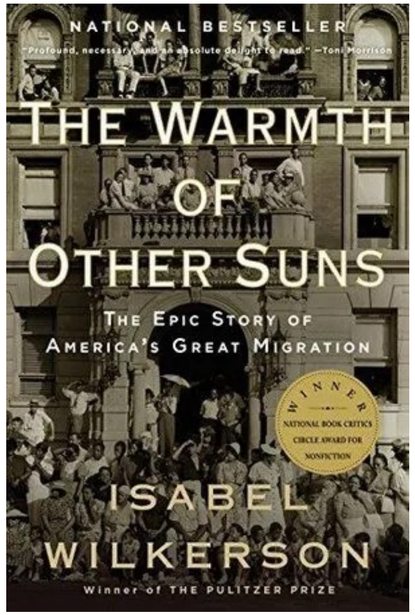
Lecture 8, Wednesday Apr 15

# the Great Migration

# Wilkerson

- "From the early years of the twentieth century to well past its middle age, nearly every black family in the American South, which meant nearly every black family in America, had a decision to make. There were **sharecroppers** losing at settlement. **Typists** wanting to work in an office. **Yard boys** scared that a single gesture near the planter's wife could leave them hanging from an oak tree. They were all stuck in a caste system as hard and unyielding as the red Georgia clay, and they each had a decision before them. In this, they were not unlike anyone who ever longed to cross the Atlantic or the Rio Grande."

- "Over the course of **six decades**, some **six million black southerners** left the land of their forefathers and **fanned out across the country** for an uncertain existence in nearly every other corner of America. The Great Migration would become a turning point in history. It would transform urban America and recast the social and political order of every city it touched. It would force the South to search its soul and finally to lay aside a feudal caste system. It grew out of the unmet promises made after the Civil War and, through the sheer weight of it, helped push the country toward the civil rights revolutions of the 1960s."

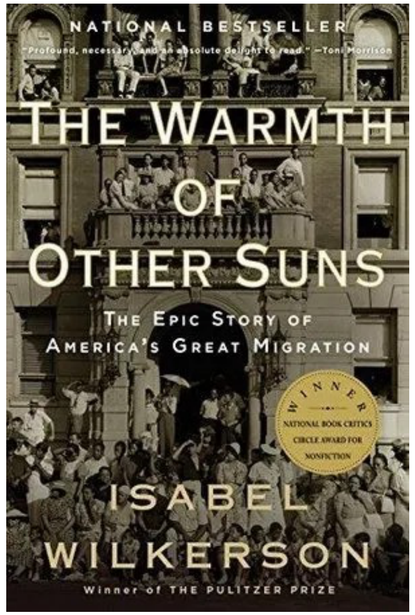



2010

# Wilkerson

- "Its imprint is everywhere in urban life. The configuration of the **cities** as we know them, the **social geography** of black and white neighborhoods, the spread of the **housing projects** as well as the rise of a well-scrubbed black middle class, along with the alternating waves of **white flight** and **suburbanization**—all of these grew, directly or indirectly, from the response of everyone touched by the Great Migration."

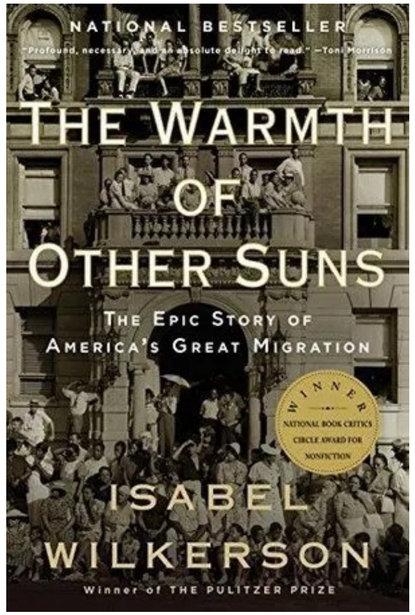
- "The Great Migration would not end until the 1970s, when the South began finally to change—the whites-only signs came down, the all-white schools opened up, and everyone could vote. By then nearly half of all black Americans—some forty-seven percent—would be living outside the South, compared to ten percent when the Migration began. ***Oftentimes, just to go away***, wrote John Dollard, a Yale scholar studying the South in the 1930s, ***is one of the most aggressive things that another person can do,*** *and if the means of expressing discontent are limited, as in this case, it is one of the few ways in which pressure can be put.*"




2010

# Wilkerson

- “By the time it was over, no northern or western city would be the same. In **Chicago** alone, the black population rocketed from 44,103 (just under three percent of the population) at the start of the Migration to more than one million at the end of it.  By the turn of the twenty-first century, blacks made up a third of the city's residents, with more blacks living in Chicago than in the entire state of **Mississippi**.”




2010

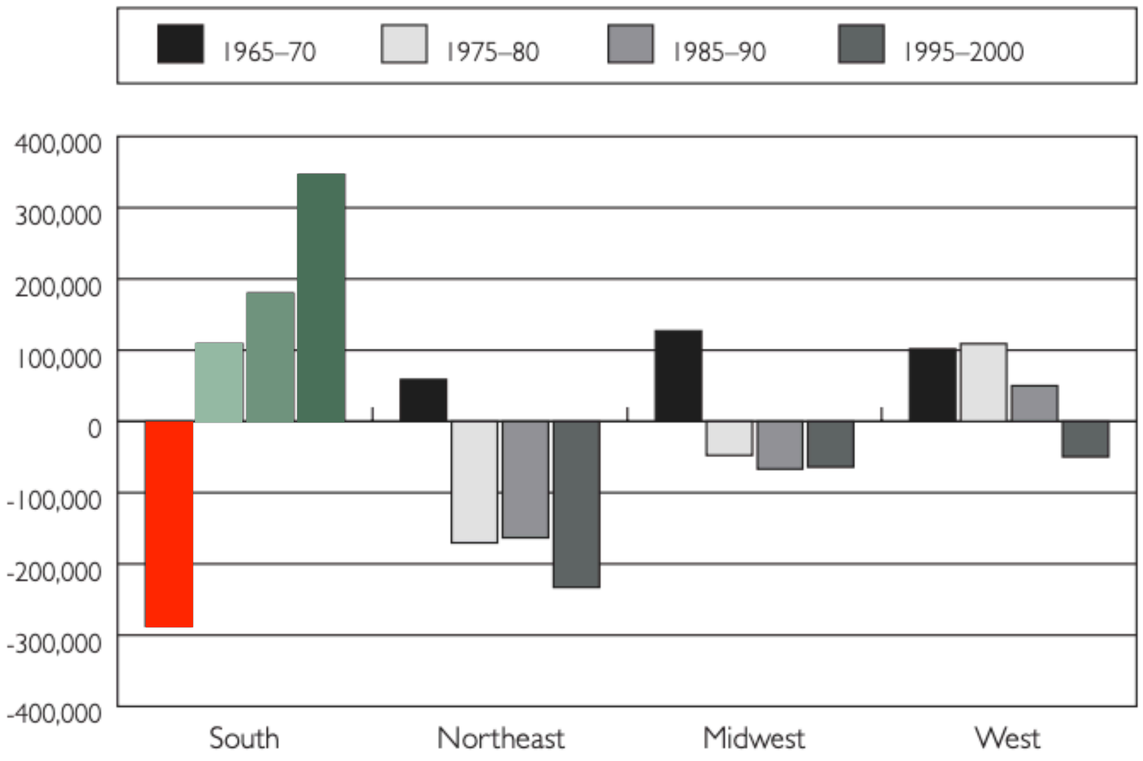
# Policy correlate: Cabrini Green

- major public housing project on Chicago's Near North Side
- built 1950s-60s, associated with mayor (and Democratic Boss) Richard **J**. Daley
- early, largely Italian — by 1960s, mostly Black
- ~15,000 people at peak, emblem of Black working class
- but not properly resourced — became known for crime, dilapidation, lack of social mobility
- demolished 1990s-2000s by Richard **M**. Daley, driving Black flight to suburbs

"Good Times" sitcom

# Now signs of "great reverse"

**Figure 1. Black Net Migration, U.S. Regions, 1965–2000**




*Source: Author's analysis of 1970, 1980, 1990 and 2000 decennial censuses.*

CENTER ON URBAN AND METROPOLITAN POLICY

## The New Great Migration:
### Black Americans' Return to the South, 1965–2000

William H. Frey

*"Recent years have completed the long-term reversal of blacks' historic out-migration from the South."*

**Findings**

An analysis of migration data from the past four decennial censuses at regional, state, and metropolitan-area levels indicates that:

- **The South scored net gains of black migrants from all three of the other regions of the U.S. during the late 1990s, reversing a 35-year trend.** Of the 10 states that suffered the greatest net loss of blacks between 1965 and 1970, five ranked among the top 10 states for attracting blacks between 1995 and 2000.
- **Southern metropolitan areas, particularly Atlanta, led the way in attracting black migrants in the late 1990s.** In contrast, the major metropolitan areas of New York, Chicago, Los Angeles, and San Francisco experienced the greatest out-migration of blacks during the same period.
- **Among migrants from the Northeast, Midwest, and West regions, blacks were more likely than whites to select destinations in the South.** Atlanta and Washington, D.C. were the top destinations for black migrants from all three regions; white migrants moved to a broader set of areas including Miami, Phoenix, and Los Angeles.
- **College-educated individuals lead the new migration into the South.** The "brain gain" states of Georgia, Texas, and Maryland attracted the most black college graduates from 1995 to 2000, while New York suffered the largest net loss.
- **After several decades as a major black migrant "magnet," California lost more black migrants than it gained during the late 1990s.** Southern states, along with western "spillover" states like Arizona and Nevada, received the largest numbers of black out-migrants from California.

This full-scale reversal of blacks' "Great Migration" north during the early part of the 20th century reflects the South's economic growth and modernization, its improved race relations, and the longstanding cultural and kinship ties it holds for black families. This new pattern has augmented a sizeable and growing black middle class in the South's major metropolitan areas.

LivingCities CensusSeries

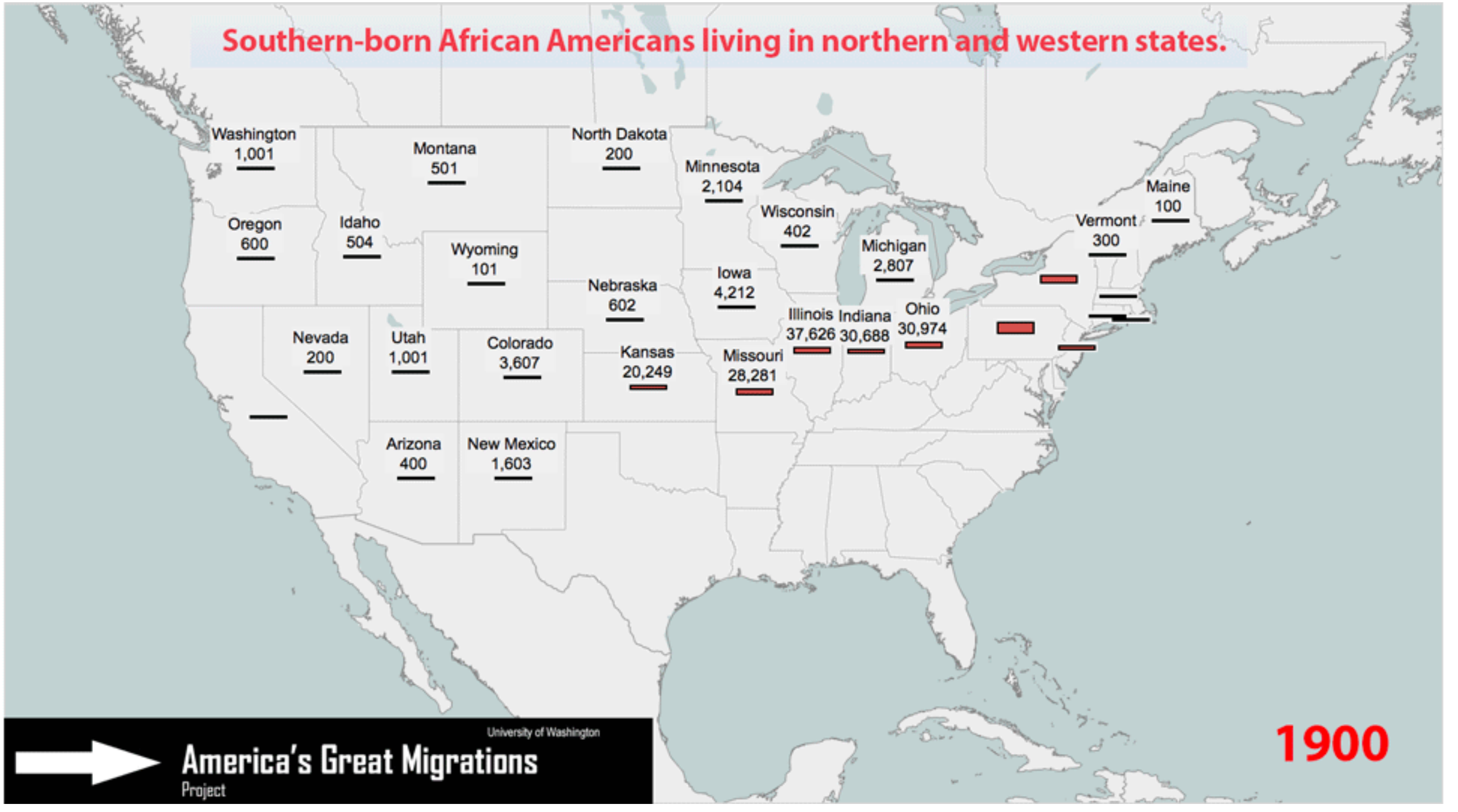
## Table 4. Top "Brain Gain" and "Brain Drain" States, Blacks and Whites, 1995–2000

| Rank | Blacks | | Whites | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | **Largest Net In-Migration of College Graduates** | | | |
| 1 | Georgia | 20,297 | Florida | 133,721 |
| 2 | Texas | 11,609 | Arizona | 69,159 |
| 3 | Maryland | 11,468 | North Carolina | 59,224 |
| 4 | Florida | 5,976 | Colorado | 51,847 |
| 5 | North Carolina | 4,016 | Georgia | 44,755 |
| 6 | Tennessee | 2,466 | California | 36,145 |
| 7 | Arizona | 2,420 | Texas | 36,102 |
| 8 | Nevada | 1,848 | Washington | 32,251 |
| 9 | Virginia | 1,018 | Nevada | 28,636 |
| 10 | Delaware | 888 | Oregon | 23,099 |
| | **Largest Net Out-Migration of College Graduates** | | | |
| 1 | New York | -18,573 | New York | -134,103 |
| 2 | Louisiana | -6,608 | Illinois | -60,847 |
| 3 | District of Columbia | -5,601 | Pennsylvania | -55,093 |
| 4 | Pennsylvania | -4,040 | Ohio | -36,575 |
| 5 | Alabama | -3,019 | Michigan | -29,510 |
| 6 | Mississippi | -2,947 | Indiana | -28,496 |
| 7 | Ohio | -2,875 | Iowa | -25,094 |
| 8 | Massachusetts | -2,389 | New Jersey | -20,763 |
| 9 | California | -2,173 | Louisiana | -20,255 |
| 10 | Oklahoma | -1,669 | Utah | -15,143 |

*Source: Author's analysis of Census 2000 data*

## Appendix C. Black Net Migration for Metropolitan Areas with Black Population Over 50,000 in 2000, 1965–2000

| Metropolitan Areas | 2000 Black Population | % of Total Population | Black Net Migration 1965–1970 | 1975–1980 | 1985–1990 | 1995–2000 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| New York-Northern New Jersey-Long Island, NY-NJ-CT-PA CMSA | 3,637,778 | 17.2 | 18,792 | -139,789 | -190,108 | -193,061 |
| Washington-Baltimore, DC-MD-VA-WV CMSA | 1,992,266 | 26.2 | 34,365 | 9,998 | 29,904 | 16,139 |
| Chicago-Gary-Kenosha, IL-IN-WI CMSA | 1,707,618 | 18.6 | 14,061 | -44,884 | -69,068 | -59,282 |
| Los Angeles-Riverside-Orange County, CA CMSA | 1,245,039 | 7.6 | 55,943 | 32,764 | -11,731 | -38,833 |
| Philadelphia-Wilmington-Atlantic City, PA-NJ-DE-MD CMSA | 1,210,846 | 19.6 | 24,601 | -16,678 | -617 | -5,479 |
| Atlanta, GA MSA | 1,189,179 | 28.9 | 10,135 | 27,111 | 74,705 | 114,478 |
| Detroit-Ann Arbor-Flint, MI CMSA | 1,149,331 | 21.1 | 54,766 | -989 | -22,432 | -15,095 |
| Miami-Fort Lauderdale, FL CMSA | 790,518 | 20.4 | 4,984 | 6,106 | 10,401 | -7,772 |
| Houston-Galveston-Brazoria, TX CMSA | 789,489 | 16.9 | 16,301 | 24,267 | -4,661 | 9,633 |
| Dallas-Fort Worth, TX CMSA | 720,133 | 13.8 | 16,384 | 12,460 | 16,097 | 39,360 |
| San Francisco-Oakland-San Jose, CA CMSA | 513,561 | 7.3 | 24,699 | 16,034 | -7,078 | -30,613 |
| New Orleans, LA MSA | 502,251 | 37.5 | -4,886 | -4,889 | -17,395 | -13,860 |

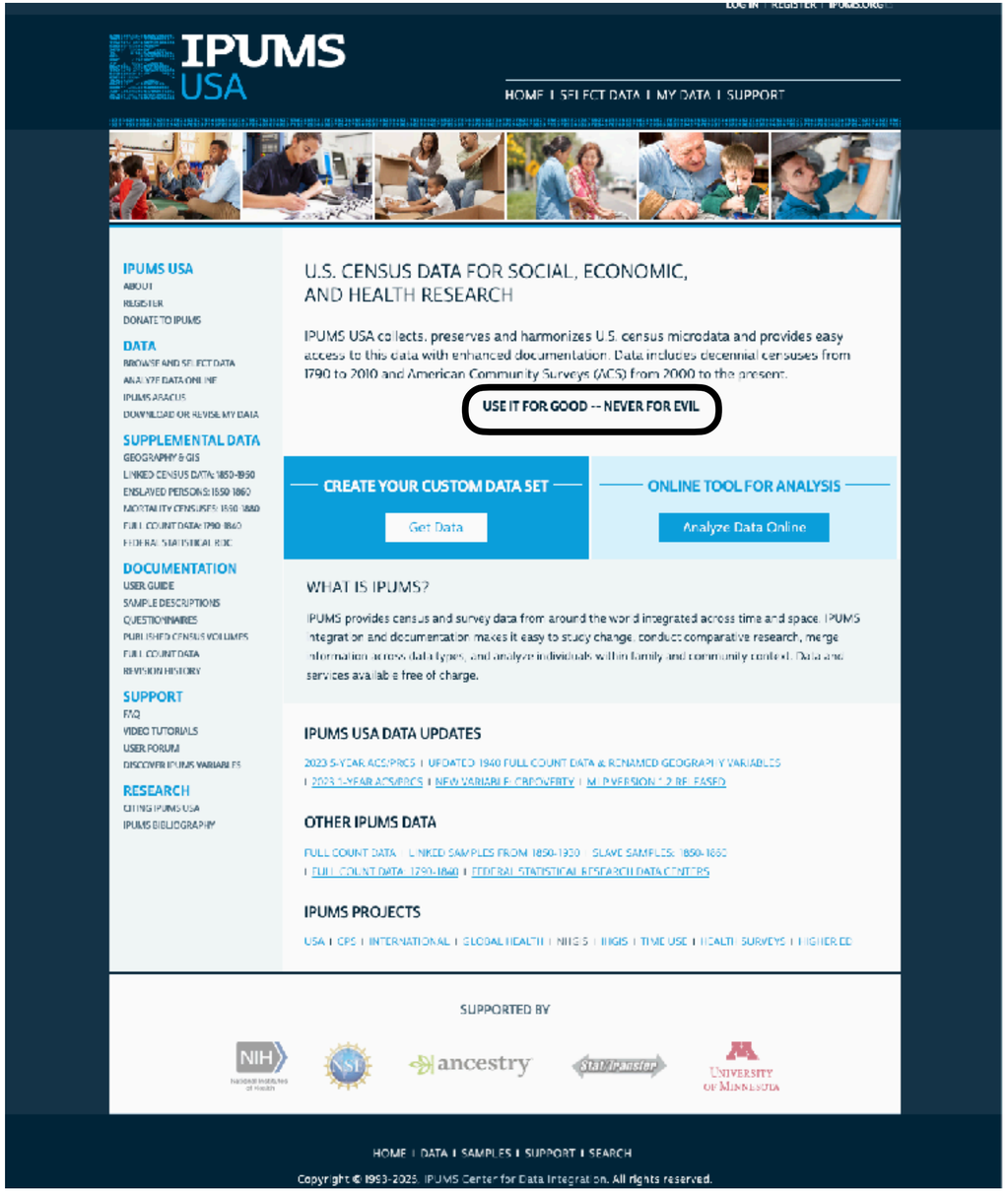

Southern-born African Americans living in northern and western states.
Washington 1,001
Montana 501
North Dakota 200
Minnesota 2,104
Maine 100
Wisconsin 402
Vermont 300
Oregon 600
Idaho 504
Wyoming 101
Michigan 2,807
Nebraska 602
Iowa 4,212
Illinois 37,626
Indiana 30,688
Ohio 30,974
Nevada 200
Utah 1,001
Colorado 3,607
Kansas 20,249
Missouri 28,281
Arizona 400
New Mexico 1,603
University of Washington
America's Great Migrations
Project
1900

# Using ACS data

- ACS gives year by year relocation numbers as a county matrix
- Not broken down by race, hard to correlate with other ACS attributes (for privacy reasons)

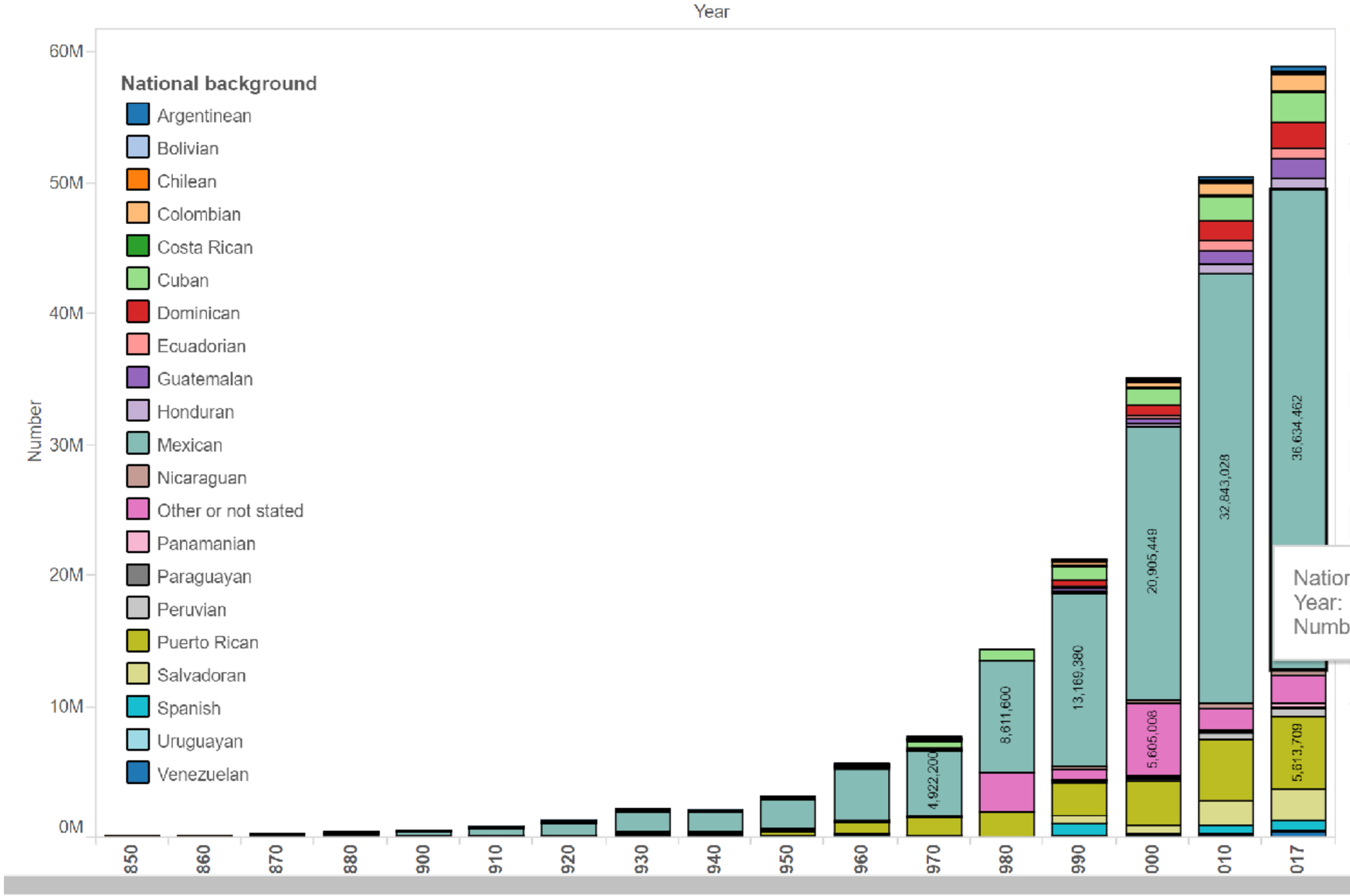
# New data source: PUMS

- New geo-unit:  the **PUMA** (Public Use Microdata Area)
- PUMS data released by Census Bureau
- IPUMS is a Minnesota-based project to integrate data sources and curate for social science use
- Includes Decennial from 1790–2010
- Includes ACS from 2000 to present
- Allows us to use point data in creative ways



## Latinx population in United States by decade

Select national background (includes US born)




National background

(All)

State

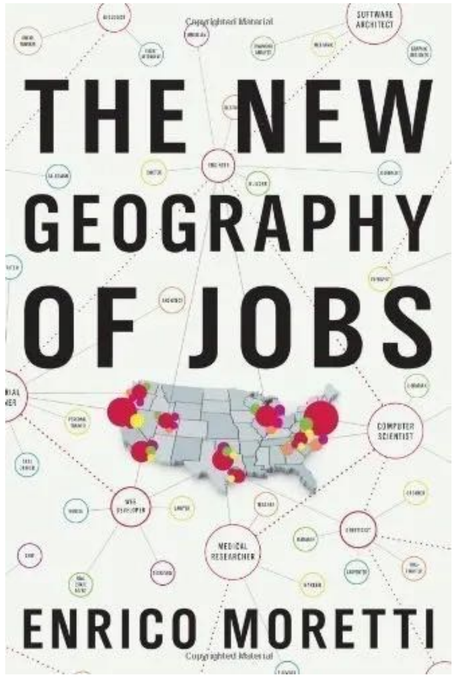
(All)

| Year | |
|---|---|
| 1850 | 111,669 |
| 1860 | 179,660 |
| 1870 | 208,022 |
| 1880 | 333,344 |
| 1900 | 496,381 |
| 1910 | 783,229 |
| 1920 | 1,215,928 |
| 1930 | 2,087,641 |
| 1940 | 2,061,919 |
| 1950 | 3,180,955 |
| 1960 | 5,645,900 |
| 1970 | 7,628,700 |
| 2017 | 58,837,861 |

National background: **Mexican**
Year: **2017**
Number: **36,634,462**

# Moretti

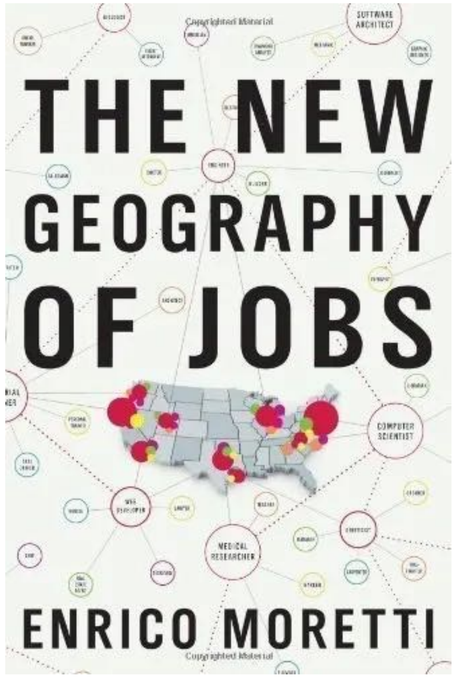
- Enrico Moretti is an economist at UC Berkeley
- Americans are enormously more mobile than residents of other industrialized countries
- He says moves often reflect seeking “stronger economies” — (possibly conflating with lower cost of living)
- Why do college grads have lowest unemployment? Perhaps not college training, but willingness to move
- Policy stagnant since 1930s — unemployment check
- Possible intervention: **mobility voucher**, benefiting both the workers willing to move and the ones who are not




2013

# Moretti

- Theory of **spatial mismatch** (Kain, Wilson) — patterns of housing, car ownership, and transit may create barriers to efficient matching of job seekers with jobs
- Universities drive mobility and improve employment, but they are subsidized by states and the states do not necessarily benefit
- Moretti argues for federal subsidies for universities (ironic in 2026)
- **Housing** policy is also essential:  housing is 40% of spending
- Homeowners gain much more from a strong economy.  Policy interventions?  Tax credits, density zoning, rent control, parking, ....

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